



the basic
idea

does free
will explain
any evil?

does free
will explain
all evil?

Mackie thinks that the free will defense is a complete failure;

free will can't explain any evil at all.

It is key to the free will defense that it is impossible for God to give us the good of free will without also letting into the universe the evil we cause with that free will.

Mackie is giving us an argument against that assumption.

**Free will
cannot
explain any
evil.**

Free will can explain some evil; but it can't explain all of the evil we find in the world.

“if God has made men such that in their free choices they sometimes prefer what is good and sometimes what is evil, why could he not have made men such that they always freely choose the good? If there is no logical impossibility in a man's freely choosing the good on one, or several occasions, there cannot be a logical impossibility in his freely choosing the good on every occasion. God was not, then, faced with a choice between making innocent automata and making beings who, in acting freely, would sometimes go wrong: there was open to him the obviously better possibility of making beings who would act freely but always go right.”

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there could be evil in a world with a omnipotent and perfectly good

Summing up so far: we have seen that Frege will promise to explain how

God. It can explain that, it seems, if we make the following assumption:

there are possible
situations which an
omnipotent
being cannot
bring about



we have
free will



free will is
a great good

the ability
to harm others
is a great good

does free
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A large orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, containing the text "does free will explain all evil?" in white, lowercase, sans-serif font.

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